Indore method

This method was developed at Indore, India. In this method organic wastes are spread in the cattle shed to serve as bedding. Trenches are dug with dimension of 10ft × 6ft × 2ft.

Dry wastes with cattle dung and soil are added in ratio of 4: 2: 1 up to 2 inches layer in composting pit. A moisture level of about 40-50% is ideal for good composting. Odour and insect problems can be controlled by covering the piles with a layer of soil or wood chips.

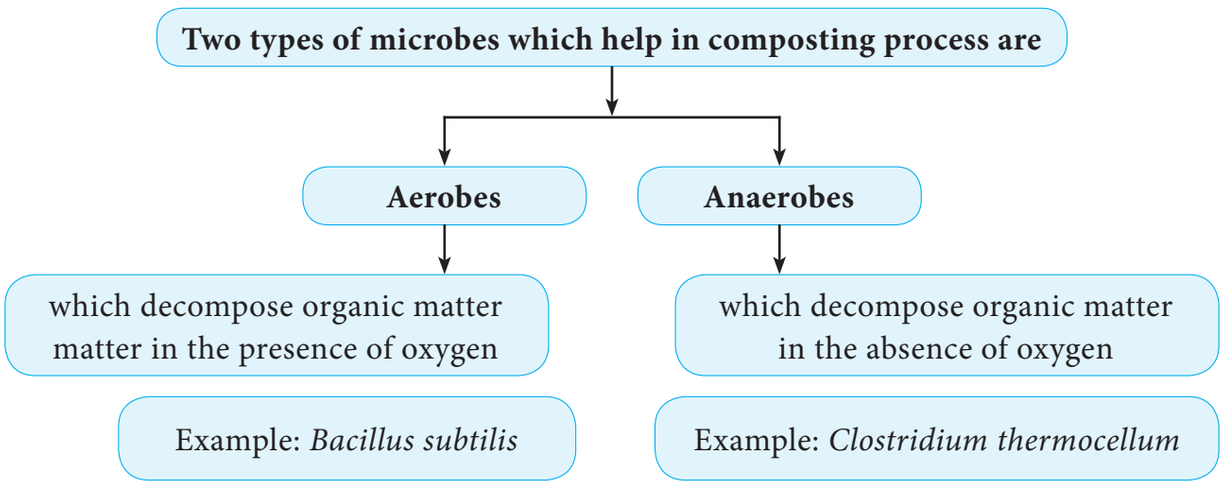
The heap is left undisturbed for about 8 to 9 months. Turning the pile for every 15 days is important for coplete composting because pile needs a periodic influx of O_2. Plant residues, weeds, sugarcane leaves, grass, wood ashes, animal dung, and water urine soaked mud can also be used as raw materials for this type of composting.

Bangalore method

- This method was developed at Bangalore, India. It is recommended as a satisfactory method for disposal of town wastes and night soil.
- The compost pits dug in soil with dimension of 4.5m × 2.5m × 90cm (L×B×H)
- In the Bangalore method of composting, dry waste material of 25cm thick is spread in a pit and a thick suspension of cow dung in water is sprinkled over for moistening.
- A thin layer of dry waste is laid over the moistened layer
- The pit is filled alternatively with dry layer of material and cow dung suspension till it rises 0.5m above the ground level and plastered with wet mud and left undisturbed for about 4-6 months or till required.
- This method saves labour cost because there is no need of turning & regular sprinkling of water.

Benefits of compost

- Compost improves the quality of soil hence called as a soil conditioner.
- Compost contains a variety of the basic nutrients required for healthy growth of the plant.
- Nitrogen, phosphorous, potassium and certain micronutrients *viz*, manganese, copper, iron and zinc are found in compost.



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